

10 AI words you need to know

SHIFT & LEAD

The 1-page reference for tool demos, proposals and meetings

01 AI

Software that recognises patterns, creates content or recommends an answer.

Ask what task it performs, what information it uses and who approves the result.

02 Generative AI

AI that creates new text, images, audio, video or code from an instruction.

Treat the output as a draft. Check facts, tone, rights and confidential information.

03 LLM

The language engine inside tools such as ChatGPT and Claude.

Judge the tool on accurate work, not the model name in the sales pitch.

04 Prompt

The request and information you give an AI so it knows what to produce.

Include the goal, evidence, limits and required format.

05 Context window

The limit on how much conversation and source material AI can consider at once.

Start a clean chat with the current brief when the work begins to drift.

06 Hallucination

A name, number, quote or source that AI invents and presents as true.

Verify every important claim in the original source before using it.

07 AI agent

AI that works through several steps and uses tools to pursue a goal.

Require approval before it sends, deletes, spends, publishes or changes records.

08 Automation

A rule that makes software complete a step when a specific event happens.

Define the trigger, expected result and what happens when it fails.

09 Connector

A link that lets AI read from another app or take an action inside it.

Grant only the access required for the task and remove it when finished.

10 RAG

Retrieval-Augmented Generation lets AI search information you choose before answering.

Keep sources current and require the answer to show which document it used.